

Holiday and Leave Policy

Annual leave, carry-over and related absence arrangements

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1. Annual leave entitlement

Annual leave entitlement is set out in each employee's contract and is based on full-time equivalent service, adjusted for part-time hours or a part-year start or finish date. The holiday year runs from 1 January to 31 December.

2. Requesting and approving leave

Leave should be requested through the leave system with as much notice as practical, and is approved by the employee's manager taking into account team cover at the time requested. Employees are encouraged to spread leave across the year rather than leaving most of it until the final months, since late requests for popular periods are less likely to be approved.

3. Carry-over

Up to five days of unused annual leave may be carried into the next holiday year, provided the carry-over is agreed with the employee's manager before the end of the current holiday year. Leave that is neither taken nor carried over by the end of the holiday year is lost and cannot be paid out instead.

4. Leaving employment

When an employee leaves the company, any annual leave that has been accrued but not yet taken is paid out along with their final salary payment. If an employee has taken more leave than they have accrued by their leaving date, the excess may be deducted from their final pay.

5. Sickness during leave

An employee who becomes genuinely unwell during a period of booked annual leave should follow the normal sickness reporting process. Days affected by illness during that period may, at the manager's discretion, be treated as sick leave rather than annual leave, provided this is reported promptly.